

James Okafor

Senior Software Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer with 10 years of experience designing and scaling distributed backend systems for fintech and e-commerce platforms. Led engineering teams of 8–12 across three product launches, consistently delivering on time and under budget. AWS Certified Solutions Architect with deep expertise in Python, Go, and Kubernetes.

EXPERIENCE

Staff Software Engineer

Monzo Bank · London, UK · Mar 2020 – Present

- Architected real-time payment processing system handling 2.4M transactions/day, reducing latency by 68% from 420ms to 134ms
- Led a team of 9 engineers to migrate monolith to 14 microservices, cutting deployment cycle from 3 weeks to 4 hours
- Designed fraud detection pipeline using ML models, preventing £3.2M in fraudulent transactions in first 6 months
- Reduced infrastructure costs by 34% (£180K annually) by optimising AWS usage and implementing auto-scaling

Senior Backend Engineer

Deliveroo · London, UK · Jun 2017 – Feb 2020

- Built order management system serving 800K daily orders across 12 countries with 99.97% uptime
- Implemented event-driven architecture using Kafka, improving system resilience and reducing data loss incidents by 94%
- Mentored 4 junior engineers, 3 of whom were promoted to senior within 18 months

Software Engineer

Skyscanner · Edinburgh, UK · Aug 2014 – May 2017

- Developed flight search aggregation service processing 50M queries per day with sub-200ms P99 latency
- Introduced automated testing suite achieving 94% code coverage, reducing production bugs by 60%

EDUCATION

MEng Computer Science — University of Edinburgh

2010 – 2014 · First Class Honours · Dissertation: Distributed Consensus Algorithms

SKILLS

Python · Go · TypeScript · PostgreSQL · Redis · Kafka · Kubernetes · Docker · AWS (EC2, RDS, Lambda, SQS) · Terraform · CI/CD · System Design · Microservices · gRPC · GraphQL

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional · 2022

Google Cloud Professional Data Engineer · 2021

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) · 2020